

Part 10: Reflection

1. Psychology of Testing: SauceDemo vs RosarioSIS

While testing SauceDemo and RosarioSIS, I approached testing with a focus on breaking the system rather than validating only expected behaviour. Instead of prioritizing happy paths, I explored negative scenarios, edge cases, and unusual inputs early in the process.

In SauceDemo, this meant testing cases such as invalid credentials, locked-out users, and unusual input formats. Because the application is relatively straightforward, this approach quickly exposed how the system handles errors, validation messages, and session control.

RosarioSIS was very complex, role-based, a deeper level of thinking due to its multi-module structure and data dependencies tracking data across steps required.

2. How did applying STLC improve your testing process across both projects?

Applying the Software Testing Life Cycle (STLC) made testing process more structured and effective across both projects.

During Requirement Analysis, I clearly identified what needed to be tested in each module.

In Test Planning, I selected appropriate testing types and tools for both applications. Test Case Design allowed me to systematically include both positive and negative scenarios, ensuring better coverage.

Test Execution became more efficient because all scenarios were predefined and organised.

Defect Reporting improved the clarity and traceability of issues using JIRA.

Finally, Test Closure helped me evaluate the overall quality of the applications and reflect on gaps.

Using STLC ensured that my testing was not random or incomplete, but instead followed a clear and professional process, improving both coverage and documentation.

2. If you were a QA engineer in a company, how would you apply lessons learned from these two projects?

As a QA engineer in a professional environment, I would apply the following lessons:

Prioritise negative and edge-case testing, not just expected user behaviour, to uncover hidden defects.

Follow structured methods like STLC to ensure consistency, traceability, and completeness.

Perform end-to-end and integration testing, especially for systems like RosarioSIS where modules are interconnected.

Use a combination of manual and automated testing to improve efficiency and coverage.

Incorporate API and performance testing to validate backend functionality and system scalability.

Document and communicate defects clearly using tools like JIRA to support collaboration with development teams.

Continuously challenge assumptions and avoid bias, ensuring a critical and analytical testing mindset.

These projects reinforced that effective testing depends not only on technical skills, but also on critical thinking, structured processes, and attention to detail, which are essential in a real-world QA role.